Yusuf:
What did you think of the study tour?

Vijay:
I will never forget the trip. I learnt to adapt with others, share with others.

Yusuf:
That's great to hear.

Unit-3

Fourteen people were killed – 10 in Tamil Nadu and four in Kerala, and life was hit as torrential rain pounded the southern districts of both the states after a deep depression in the Bay of Bengal transformed into Cyclone Ockhion Thursday and became a severe cyclonic storm on Friday, moving to the Arabian Sea. The Navy rescued eight fishermen caught in choppy waters and intensified search for 30 others who ware missing. Both state governments have put the disaster management team on high alert as the severe cyclonic storm, lying 60 km south of Kanyakumari, was expected to dump more rain in south Tamil Nadu and Kerala in the next 24 hours. It was expected to move toward the Lakshadweep archipelago in the Arabian sea and hit the islands on Saturday.

Unit-4

A full thirty days after Ramzan comes Id. It is a glorious morning. Look at this morning's sun. How lovely! As if it were congratulating the world on this day of Id. The villagers are getting ready to go to the Idgah. It will be late getting back from the Idgah. A walk of three miles, meeting and greeting hundreds of people; it would be impossible to return before noon!

The boys are the happiest. Some had kept only a single fast, some not even that. Fasting is for grown-ups and old people. But the joy of the boys going to the Idgah cannot be diminished. They were counting the days, and at last the day has arrived. Now they are impatient.

Their own pockets bulge with coins, like the stomach of the pot-bellied Kubera, the Hindu God of wealth. They are forever taking the treasure out of their pockets and counting and re-counting it before putting it back. Out of this countless hoard, they will buy countless things – toys, sweets, trumpets, balls, and much more.

The happiest of all was Hamid. This boy was four or five years old, and thin and scrawny. His father had died of cholera the previous year and his mother bade farewell to the world. Hamid now lived with his grandmother Amina, slept in her protective arms and was just as happy as ever. Hamid had no shoes on his feet and the cap on his head was soiled and tattered. Nevertheless, he was happy. Poor Amina sits in her hovel and cries. Today is Id and she does not have a grain of food in the house. But what about Hamid? He is not concerned with the harsh realities of life. In his heart, there is brightness; in his mind, there is hope.

Hamid enters the hut and tells his grandmother, "You must not worry, Amma. I'll come back before anyone else. Don't be afraid of me."

Amina feels a tightening around her heart. Other children in the village are all going with their fathers. The only father Hamid has is Amina. How can she send him alone to the crowded fair? If he gets lost, who will help him? No, Amina would not let him go alone.

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